Bibi’s idea of dividing the city, and wait for the right political leadership that won’t think about this.” And so they continue to move in, many of them families with young children, even though they are seen as unwelcome interlopers; with their security details, and their ideological motives, bits of the neighborhood feel almost like Hebron. In 2016, the government approved construction of a new three-story building in the district, earmarked for Israeli Jews.

“It contains the seeds of the Hebronisation of Jerusalem,” said Daniel Seidemann, an Israeli lawyer and Jerusalem expert. “[It] morphs the conflict from a political one, which can be solved, to a religious conflict that cannot.”

“Second-class citizens”

A few days after Shalloudi’s hit-and-run attack, I was in Kafr Kanna, a Palestinian village of 20,000 people in the northern Galilee with a rich history. Christians believe it is built on the ruins of Cana, where Jesus transformed water to wine. Two millennia later, it is largely indistinguishable from the other villages that line the highways in northern Israel, a sleepy place filled with furniture stores and automotive repair shops.

But it erupted in November 2014 after police killed a 21-year-old resident named Khair al-Din Hamdan. They said he was shot after trying to stab a group of officers; Luba Samri, a spokeswoman, said the police first fired in the air, and only shot Hamdan when they continued to “face undeterred danger”. A surveillance video quickly disproved the official narrative. It showed Hamdan banging on the windows of the police van with an object in his hands—perhaps a knife, though it was impossible to tell. He turned and started to walk away, but an officer soon emerged and shot him multiple times in the back. Two others dragged Hamdan’s limp body into the van and shut the doors before it sped away.

For days after the shooting, young men from the village had been blocking a major roadway with burning tires and throwing stones at the police. The mood was deeply insular and hostile, something of a rarity at protests here, where even the most violent participants typically allow journalists to work unmolested. (I was punched in the face at one point amidst a crowd of rioters who thought I was a Jewish Israeli.)